

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a magazine about 'emotional traps':

Coping with emotional traps

Working in groups is common in school – whether conducting experiments together, working on homework assignments, or co-operating during extra-curricular activities. Sometimes in the group, we meet people who are difficult to work with and we end up arguing with them. We get angry and frustrated, falling into something which experts call an 'emotional trap' that prevents us from achieving success when working together.

Emotional traps are negative emotions caused by something small like a group member annoying you, or something big like fighting with a friend. It is easy to fall into emotional traps; the key is *how* you react when someone upsets you, through a process called 'unhooking'. Unhooking means freeing yourself from all sorts of emotional traps.

There are three steps to unhooking. First, unhook physically by doing something physical to release the negative energy to calm down, for instance, running, walking or simply splashing water on your face. Secondly, unhook mentally by examining the facts of the situation objectively, instead of emotionally. For example, instead of focusing on how upset you are at the situation, focus on what the solutions are to the situation. Lastly, unhook verbally by not blaming or scolding people, which could cause more conflicts or arguments.

Unhook yourself from emotional traps today!

Your group has to give a talk to a Secondary One class about working with people and solving conflicts. Discuss with your group what to include in your talk. You may want to talk about:

- the difficulties people face when working in a group
- ways to solve or avoid conflicts or arguments
- the benefits of working well in a group
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you prefer working in a group or alone?
2. If you were angry with your friend, what would you do?
3. In group projects, who should choose the group members – teachers or students?
4. Have you had any positive experiences working in a group?
5. How would you deal with a lazy group member?
6. Would you like your school results to be based on 100% group work?
7. Do you find it easy to free yourself from emotional traps?
8. Would you rather win an argument or maintain a friendship?